

Spanish A1 — Week 2 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 2

Theme: **Estar / States, Emotions, Location / Ser vs. Estar**

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 2 introduces *estar* — the second essential Spanish verb. You already know *ser*. This week you will learn when to use each one.

In short:

- **Ser** — who you are, where you are from, what you do (*Soy profesora. Soy de México.*)
- **Estar** — how you feel, where you are right now (*Estoy cansada. Estoy en casa.*)

By the end of this week, you will be able to describe your current state and location in Spanish, and you will begin to develop an instinct for which verb to use when.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 2

By the end of Session 4, you should be able to say something like:

Soy de Argentina. Soy diseñadora. Hoy estoy un poco cansada pero estoy bien. Estoy en casa ahora. Mi compañera de trabajo está en la oficina — creo que está estresada porque tiene una reunión importante.

And answer these questions spontaneously:

- *¿Cómo estás?* — *Estoy muy bien, gracias.*
 - *¿Dónde estás?* — *Estoy en casa / en el trabajo.*
 - *¿De dónde eres?* — *Soy de...*
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One Thing That Surprises Students This Week

Spanish has two separate words where English has one. "Is" in English translates to either *es* or *está* depending on what you mean:

- *Ella es médica.* — She is a doctor. (identity)
- *Ella está cansada.* — She is tired. (state)

This is not an exception or a quirk — it is how Spanish works. Both verbs are "correct." The one you choose changes your meaning.

The good news: the most common uses follow a simple pattern. Emotions and location almost always take *estar*. Profession and origin almost always take *ser*. Start there, and the edge cases will make more sense over time.

Your Reference Handout

You have access to a *Ser vs. Estar* Reference — a separate document included in your Week 2 materials. Use it when you are unsure. It includes:

- A side-by-side comparison of the most common uses
- High-frequency example sentences
- The four adjectives that change meaning depending on the verb
- A 10-item practice section with answers

You do not need to memorize this handout. Use it as a reference while you practice, and the patterns will become intuitive.

A Note on Ser vs. Estar

You will make mistakes with *ser* and *estar*. Every Spanish learner does — even advanced learners. The goal this week is not to eliminate errors; it is to understand why the two verbs exist and develop a usable first instinct.

Your instructor will correct *ser/estar* errors consistently throughout the course. Each correction is a data point, not a failure.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 3 — before Session 4:

1. **Say *estar* from memory.** *estoy, estás, está, estamos, estáis, están*. Three times out loud.
2. **Write your 5 sentences.** Homework Part 2 — how you feel, where you are, where people you know are.
3. **Read the reference handout.** Skim it once. You do not need to memorize it.

After Session 4 — before Session 5:

1. **Review the *ser/estar* framework.** Can you give one example sentence for each of the 8 use cases?
 2. **Finish your written description.** Homework Part 3 — 5–7 sentences using both verbs.
 3. **Say your description out loud.** Close your notes on the second try.
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Vocabulary to Know Before Week 3

You will find the full Week 2 vocabulary list in your Week 2 Vocabulary Reference. The most important items for Session 5 are:

- All six forms of *estar* from memory
 - 6–8 emotion/state words with their gender agreement (*cansado/a, nervioso/a, contento/a...*)
 - Core location phrases: *en casa, en el trabajo, en clase, aquí, cerca*
 - The four meaning-changing adjectives: *aburrido/a, listo/a, bueno/a, seguro/a*
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